Lahore Resolution





Lahore Resolution 1940

Lahore Session – March 1940

- With the clarity of mind and backing of the Muslim community behind him, Quaid-i-Azam called for the 27th annual session of All India Muslim League to be held from March 22 to 24, 1940 at Lahore.
- Session was presided by Quaid-i-Azam Muhammad Ali Jinnah
- Attendance: Delegates from all over India
- Rising political tensions and communal divide

Policy Shift

- The Lahore **Resolution of 1940 is a significant document**. It's a document of primary importance in the history of Pakistan
- The resolution signified a change of direction of the Muslim Movement.
- **It identified a new destination, it was basically a change of strategy.** Previously, the talks were for Federalism, provincial autonomy, constitutional safeguards and guarantees
- In Lahore Resolution **Muslim League officially talked about separatism**, a separate state or the partition of India. This was something which they thought was needed **for achieving the primary goal and that was the protection and promotion of Muslim identity and Muslim interests in the Indo-Pak Sub Continent**

Political Conditions till 1940: Paving Way for the Resolution

- Nehru Report (1928)
- Jinnah’s Fourteen Point (1929)
- Iqbal’s Allahabad Address (1930)
- Congress ministries (1937–1939)
- Growing dissatisfaction among Muslims
- British indifference toward Muslim concerns
- Muslim League's rising popularity under Jinnah’s leadership

Key Highlights of the Resolution

- Official name: Lahore Resolution commonly known as Pakistan Resolution
- Demanded “independent states” for Muslims in the North-Western and Eastern zones
- No specific mention of the name “Pakistan”
- Advocated full autonomy and sovereignty for Muslim-majority areas
- Rejection of Indian federation proposed by Congress

Text Extract – The Lahore Resolution

“… No constitutional plan would be workable or acceptable to the Muslims unless it is designed on the following basic principles, viz, that geographically contiguous units are demarcated into regions which should be so constituted, with such territorial readjustment as may be necessary that the areas where the Muslims are numerically in majority, as in the North Western and Eastern zones of India, should be grouped to constitute "Independent States" in which the constituent units shall be autonomous and sovereign”

Text Extract – The Lahore Resolution:

- “The Muslims are a separate nation because their customs, traditions, civilizations, culture and above all religion is different from Hindus. Inspite of the fact that they had been living together for centuries, both have their distinctive identification. If the Sub-continent gets freedom in the form of United India, the rights of the Muslims will not be protected.”
- Jinnah further emphasized that "The demand of the Muslims for a separate country is not unhistorical. Ireland got freedom from England; Spain and Portugal became separate states; Czechoslovakia got a separate identification as a result of the partition. The problem in India is not of an inter-communal character but manifestly of an international one, and it must be treated as such." He concluded his speech while saying that "British India is a sub-continent. It is not a country or homeland of a nation. Many nations are living here and their interest is separate from one another.

Role of Key Leaders

- **Quaid-i-Azam Jinnah:** Visionary leadership
  - Two-Nation Theory reaffirmed
- **A.K. Fazlul Huq:** Presented the resolution
- **Liaquat Ali Khan:** Strategic political support
- **Sikandar Hayat Khan-** along with others Drafter of the Resolution, and facilitator
- **Chaudhry Khaliquzzaman,** and others
- Nine membered committee drafted it that included: Muhammad Ali Jinnah, Liaquat Ali Khan, Sikandar Hayat Khan, Khawaja Nazimuddin, Abdullah Haroon, and Nawab Ismail Khan

Reaction to the Resolution

- Congress outrage and media backlash
- British cautious response
- Hindu press mockingly called it the “Pakistan Resolution”
- Sparked communal debates across India

Hindu Reaction

- The Hindu reaction was, of course, quick, bitter and malicious. **They called the "Pakistan" demand "anti-national."**
- They **characterized it as "vivisection; above all, they denounced it as imperialist** – inspired to obstruct India's march to freedom".
- In denouncing the demand outright, they, however, missed the central fact of the Indian political situation; the astonishingly tremendous response of the Pakistan demand had elicited from the Muslim masses

British Reaction

- The British were equally **hostile to the Muslim demand** for at least two important reasons:
    - **First**, they had long considered themselves as the architects of the unity of India and of an Indian nation
    - **Second**, they had long regarded the super-imposed unity under Pax Britannica as their greatest achievement and lasting contribution in history.
- The Pakistan demand threatened to undo these presumed achievements on which the British had long prided

Significance of the Pakistan Resolution

- New Political Destiny
- First formal political demand for a separate homeland
- brought political & religious leaders to work together for the Muslim State
- Shifted Muslim League from minority rights to nationhood demand
- Foundation stone for future demand of Pakistan in 1947
- Muslim League as Party was also re-organized in the different parts of the India

From Lahore Resolution to Pakistan

- 1940 Lahore Resolution
- 1941 Civil Disobedience Movement
- 1942 Crips Mission
- 1942 Quit India Movement
- 1945 Simla Conference
- Cabinet Mission
- The June 3rd Plan
- Radcliffe Award
- Transfer of Power

Legacy of the Pakistan Resolution

- Celebrated annually as *Pakistan Day* (23rd March)
- Monument: *Minar-e-Pakistan* built at the historic site
- Basis of Pakistan’s ideological and political foundation